



EXIT STORIES #001

Little Eye Labs. Facebook's first India deal. The full write-up.

Series · Exit Stories (Fri)

Date · 24 Jul 2026

Subject · Little Eye Labs, Bengaluru

Framework · Own the capability

01 Carousel caption (posts 08:00 IST)

Facebook's first-ever acquisition in India wasn't a big consumer app. It was a 13-person team in Bengaluru.

In January 2014, Facebook bought Little Eye Labs for a reported \$10 to \$15 million.

Little Eye solved a boring, painful problem in mobile app performance. In 2013, an Android app was a black box. You couldn't see why one drained the battery, ate data, or lagged.

Plug any Android phone into a laptop and Little Eye showed CPU, memory, battery and data in real time, tied to what the app was doing. Zero code.

Here's why Facebook cared. That year, 874 million of its 1.19 billion users were on mobile. Android ran 80% of the world's phones. Facebook needed lighter, faster apps for the next billion people.

Little Eye wasn't 13 people. It was a capability Facebook couldn't build fast enough.

That's the startup exit lesson. Great acquisitions aren't about your size. They're about the problem you own. Don't build to get bought. Build to own a capability someone bigger will one day need.

💬 Who would acquire your startup, and why?

❤️ Save this for your founding team.

📖 Sources: TechCrunch, YourStory, Business Today

⚠️ Editorial analysis of publicly available information.

#startup #acquisition #startupindia #founders #buildinpublic

SEO Keywords (one line, comma-separated, for captions, alt text, cross-posting, YouTube/blog)

little eye labs, facebook little eye labs acquisition, facebook first india acquisition, indian startup acquired by facebook, bengaluru startup acquisition, android app performance tool, startup acquisition lessons, why facebook acquired little eye labs, acqui-hire india, startup exit story india, mobile app performance analysis, indian tech startup exit, kumar rangarajan, gsf accelerator, capability acquisition, startup exit strategy, india startup ecosystem, facebook android optimization, deep tech startup india, build to be acquired



02 Reel captions

REEL 1 · PRIMARY · 30S · 09:00

Facebook's first-ever India acquisition was a 13-person Bengaluru startup: Little Eye Labs.

They built an Android app performance tool that showed why any app drained battery, data and memory. In 2013, 874 million of Facebook's users were on mobile, and it needed lighter apps for the next billion. Little Eye was that capability.

The startup exit lesson: acquirers buy the problem you own, not your size.

Follow @statupsutra for Exit Stories, every Friday.

 Sources: TechCrunch, YourStory.

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REEL 2 · MICRO · 16S · 13:00

Facebook bought a 13-person Bengaluru startup in 2014: Little Eye Labs. Why?

It owned the Android app performance capability Facebook urgently needed for the next billion users.

The startup exit lesson: great exits aren't about size, they're about the capability you own.

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03 Alt text 7 slides

- Slide 1.** Exit Stories, Little Eye Labs. Facebook bought a 13-person Bengaluru startup in January 2014 for about 10 to 15 million dollars. Its first India deal.
- Slide 2.** Snapshot: Little Eye Labs, Bengaluru, founded 2012, 13 people and 5 founders, backed by GSF Accelerator and Ventureast, raised about 282K then acquired. Timeline: 2012 founded, April 2013 launch, January 2014 Facebook.
- Slide 3.** The problem: in 2013 a mobile app was a black box. Nobody could see why it drained battery, ate data, or lagged, especially on cheap Android phones.
- Slide 4.** What they built: plug any Android phone in over USB and Little Eye showed CPU, memory, battery and data live, correlated to app activity. Zero code.
- Slide 5.** Why Facebook bought them: 874 million of its 1.19 billion users were on mobile and Android ran 80% of the world's phones. Facebook needed lighter, faster apps. Little Eye was that capability.
- Slide 6.** Founder lesson: Facebook didn't buy 13 people, it bought a capability it couldn't build fast enough. Acquirers pay for the problem you solve, not team size.
- Slide 7.** Your move: who would acquire your startup, and why. Build to own a capability someone bigger will need. Follow @statupsutra, Exit Stories every Friday.

04 Hashtags and timing

CORE (ALWAYS)

#startup #acquisition #startupindia #founders #buildinpublic

EXTENDED (MAX REACH)

#exit #techindia #bengaluru #facebook #startupstory #entrepreneurship #productmanagement

No active company to tag (Little Eye was absorbed into Meta in 2014). Optional editorial tag: **@meta**. Verify any handle first.

RECOMMENDED IST SCHEDULE

TIME	ASSET
08:00	Carousel , slides 1 to 7
13:30	Reel 2 , micro (16s)
20:00	Reel 1 , primary (30s)

Spread across morning, lunch and evening for an India-first professional audience. Add a trending in-app audio to both reels.